Xudong Zhu

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Education

Mar. 2025 – Present	Ph.D. Candidate, International History, **University of Aberdeen**, Aberdeen, UK. Dissertation: *Weapons, Warlords, and Order: Strategic Cooperation Between China and Germany in a Time of Global Transition (1928–1938)*. Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Thomas Weber; Dr. Andrew Dilley. Fields: applied history, grand strategy, global security.
Oct. 2021 – Aug. 2023	M.A., American Studies (Political Science and History track), **Ruprecht-Karls-Universität Heidelberg**, Heidelberg, Germany. Thesis: *On the Theory of Empire in International Relations and an Analysis of Pax Americana*. Selected coursework: U.S. economic policy, the Transatlantic alliance, nuclear deterrence theory, political psychology, and varieties of American conservatism.
Sep. 2017 – Jun. 2021	LL.B., Diplomacy, **Jilin University**, Changchun, China. Selected coursework: international history, theories of international relations, foreign policy analysis, international law, power politics, and political philosophy.

Professional Memberships

2025 – Present	Postgraduate Member, Royal Historical Society.
2025 – Present	Member, Association of Chinese Political Studies.

Teaching

2025/26	Teaching Assistant, University of Aberdeen, Aberdeen, UK. *HI1022: Europe in the Twentieth Century*. *HI2520: Global Empire in the Long Nineteenth Century*.
Summer 2023	Tutor, Ruprecht-Karls-Universität Heidelberg, Heidelberg, Germany. *From Washington to Peking: A History of Early Interactions Between the U.S. and China*

Peer-Reviewed Book Chapter

2026. "How to Maintain a Balance in the Intricate *Pas de Trois* among China, US and EU." In *The Trilateral Interactions: China, the US, and the EU on Tensions, Competition, and Cooperation*, edited by Zuokui Liu, Marek Hrubec, and Shaohua Yan. London: Routledge (with Wang Li) doi:10.4324/9781003736554-8.

Prize Essay

2025. "Trump as the (In)advertent Harbinger of a New Transatlantic Security Architecture: Europe's Autonomy as a Bulwark Against Chinese Influence.". Runner-up, Jimmy Carter Prize, China Focus Essay Contest.

Contributions to Conferences

2026. "Bypassing the Diplomats: Bureaucratic Politics and the Formulation of Sino-German Strategic Cooperation, 1928–1930", *British International History Group (BIHG) Annual Conference 2026*, Loughborough University.

2025. "Beyond Divide and Rule: Advocating a Respect-Based Chinese Policy Toward the European Union", *Annual Conference of the Association of Chinese Political Studies (ACPS)*, King's College London.

2022. "What to Do About the Strategic Challenge? An Analysis of the Background of NATO's New China Strategy", *Seventh Annual Young Scholars Forum on U.S.–China Relations*, The Carter Center.

Selected Public Writing

Contributing Writer, U.S.–China Perception Monitor (The Carter Center)

"Improving U.S.-China Relations: Ten Thousand Years Is Too Long; Seize the Day." May 18, 2026. (English)

"Towards Europe's Strongest Conventional Armed Force: An Outline of *Gesamtkonzeption der militärischen Verteidigung*." April 30, 2026. (Chinese)

"If Bismarck Ran Washington: What Approach Would He Take to U.S.–China Relations?" December 11, 2025. (Chinese)

"From The Art of the Deal to The Art of Diplomacy: The Continuities in Trump's View of International Relations." September 11, 2025. (Chinese)

Digital Humanities Projects

2026 — *BismAI: A Bismarck-Persona Fine-Tune of Gemma 4 E4B*. Sole author.

LoRA fine-tune of Google's Gemma 4 E4B Instruct base model, trained to adopt the rhetorical and strategic voice of Otto von Bismarck for historical-persona research and teaching.

huggingface.co/Ottomin/BismAI-V2

Professional and Research Experience

Jun. – Aug. 2025 — Research Intern, Experience, Engagement & Wellbeing Team, University of Aberdeen, Aberdeen, UK.

Conducted qualitative research on international students' study journeys across undergraduate, postgraduate-taught, and ISC/Language Centre cohorts; produced strategy roadmaps to enhance the student experience.

Coordinated communication across academic and professional-services departments and contributed to orientation materials for incoming international students.

Jun. – Sep. 2020 — Academic Assistant, U.S.–China Perception Monitor, The Carter Center, Atlanta, USA (remote).

Translated and edited articles on U.S.–China relations for the centre's bilingual platform. Co-organised eight academic conferences and authored proceedings summaries. Interviewed policy scholars and wrote articles averaging over 5,000 readers.

2019	"International and European Studies" programme, University of Tübingen.
2018	Summer programme, Rutgers, The State University of New Jersey.
2017	Field study on national security and border control along the China–North Korea border, Jilin University.

Awards

2025	Runner-up, Jimmy Carter Prize, China Focus Essay Contest.
2018	Excellence Award, 16th National Diplomatic Etiquette Competition.
2018	Best Negotiator, 3rd Simulated Diplomatic Negotiation Competition, Jilin University.
2017	Diplomatic Award, 1st Simulated Diplomatic Spokesperson Competition, Jilin University.

Service

Completed 120 hours of volunteer service with the Red Cross Society.

Moderator, Academic Forum at the School of International and Public Affairs (SIPA), Jilin University, 2018-2021

Event staff, the 6th China-South Korea Public Diplomacy Research Forum, Changchun, 2018

Research assistant to Prof. Swaran Singh (Jawaharlal Nehru University) during his visit to Jilin University, 2018

Languages

Chinese (native), English (proficient), German (proficient).